# Afonso Leote

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## Education

**MSc in Computer Science and Engineering** Sept. 2024 – Present
*NOVA School of Science and Technology, NOVA University Lisbon* *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Current GPA: 19/20, Pedagogical Committee member
- Relevant coursework: Game Theory (20/20), Machine Learning (19/20), Deep Learning (19/20), Unsupervised Learning (20/20), Computer Vision (19/20), Vision and Language Processing Systems (20/20), NLP (19/20).

**BSc in Computer Science and Engineering** Sept. 2021 – July 2024
*NOVA School of Science and Technology, NOVA University Lisbon* *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Final GPA: 18/20
- Relevant coursework: Probability and Statistics (20/20), Software Engineering (19/20), Databases (18/20), Artificial Intelligence (18/20), Distributed Systems (18/20), Computer Networks (18/20), Graph Theory (20/20).

## Publications

[1] **On the Performance of Concept Probing: The Influence of the Data.** Oct. 2025
*Manuel de Sousa Ribeiro,* ***Afonso Leote****, João Leite.* *Bologna, Italy*

- In Proceedings of the 28th European Conference on Artificial Intelligence (ECAI'25)

[2] **Concept Probing: Where to Find Human-Defined Concepts** Sept. 2025
*Manuel de Sousa Ribeiro,* ***Afonso Leote****, João Leite.* *Santa Cruz, United States*

- In Proceedings of the 19th International Conference on Neurosymbolic Learning and Reasoning (NeSy'25)

## Experience

**Graduate Research Assistant** Sept. 2024 – Present
*NOVA LINCS – Laboratory for Computer Science and Informatics* *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Supervised by Prof. João Leite, we worked in the field of Explainable AI, investigating several characteristics of concept probing, with a focus on: (i) methods to pinpoint units that represent concepts; (ii) how the amount, quality, and origin of data affect probing; and (iii) methods to quantify the semantic alignment of a concept probe.

## Awards

**MSc Research Grants** 2024, 2026
*NOVA LINCS* *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Selected for a funded graduate researcher position in Project FAIR (2024.16987.PEX.)
- Awarded a funded research position in Project PRR STONE (C644943391-00000051/40)

**Top Student Award** 2023
*NOVA University Lisbon* *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Merit scholarship awarded to the top students of the university for the 2023–2024 academic year (18.65/20).

## Volunteer

**Volunteer Staff at the FLoC'26** July 2026
*ISCTE - University Institute of Lisbon* *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Member of the organizing staff for the 9th Federated Logic Conference, bringing together multiple conferences. Contributed to session coordination, Q&A facilitation, and general conference logistics in KR 2026 and CP 2026.

**Volunteer Staff at EXPO FCT'23** April 2023
*NOVA University Lisbon* *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Helped organize, set up, and welcome high school students to the Department of Computer Science of NOVA FCT.

## Technical Skills

**Programming**: Python, Java, SQL, R, ASP (Clingo).
**Frameworks**: PyTorch, pandas, Matplotlib, NumPy, Git, Azure, Kubernetes
**Other**: Linux, LaTeX